

of mouse pointer makes the job easy. The “mouse auto-capture” feature makes sure that when you have more than one application window running on the host and the VM window is one of them, the VM is able to use the mouse pointer as and when you hover over the window and leave the pointer when you pull the mouse pointer out of its boundaries. It allows you to be fast when you’re working with a guest machine as well as a few other applications open on your system.

Another feature which eases up the work flow is a “bi-directional” clipboard. With an intuitive name, it allows you to do a [Ctrl +C] on your host OS to copy some text and paste it into your guest OS and vice versa. At times, it also allows you to copy files from the guest machine to the host and vice versa. If this is present, you might start feeling that the shared folders feature is an unnecessary one (although it has more uses than the obvious copy-paste operations).

When you’re into virtualization, you’d want to have all of this at hand. Virtual machines are more than just for play and can be used for quite productive uses. When you’re in need of a feature within a virtual environment and you don’t have it, you start feeling locked in. Options would be limited and you may just start pulling out your hair in clumps. The best way to avoid such situations is to plan ahead – about your choice of OS inside the VM, applications you’re going to run within and the kind of load they’ll put on your machine, the networking and file-sharing features and so on. We hope you’re well informed by now about the features you need to look for. When we discuss a triplet of great software available for the use (that’s next), we believe you’d be able to choose the best for yourself. With all that mind, we’d like to repeat a phrase the late Steve Jobs was known to have said many a time – “it should just, work” .